Pandey's team got to work again. This time, they came up with a series of animation commercials that linked politics to cricket. The first one was a classic. An umpire goes for the toss with the captains, only to find one captain is missing. The punchline is *'Bina kaptan ki team khai maar, abki baar Modi Sarkar'* (A team without a captain loses, this time vote for a Modi government). 'I don't think anyone has used animation in a political campaign. People just loved it. It showed that voting for Modi was a "cool" thing to do!' Pandey told me. Seventeen animation films were done—often four or five in a night—and plastered right through the T20 and IPL season.

The cricket ads were only a bridge before the final assault on the eve of elections in April. If the first phase of creatives in the build-up had been about anger, round two would be about 'hope'. Another simple message to communicate the idea of 'Modi = Hope' was needed. The concept '*Achhe Din Aanewale Hain*' (Good days are coming) was born, the line and song attributable to Soho Square's creative head, Anurag Khandelwal.

When the presentation was made to the BJP team at 1 Lodhi Estate, opinion was divided. Some BJP leaders were worried that the 'acche din' focus could become another India Shining, the 2004 BJP campaign that had gone so terribly wrong. 'Should we be raising hopes of people so soon?' was the query. This time, Jaitley and Sushma, for once, were on the same side. The country was steeped in negativism, Modi was offering a shift in mood—the 'acche din' idea was approved. The line would stick in the minds of millions.

In a telephone conversation with my son Ishan who is studying medicine in Manipal in Karnataka, I asked him what the election buzz was on campus. *'Dad, achche din aanewale hain!'* he replied. Clearly, the BJP was onto another winner.

The backstory of the BJP's ad campaign reveals much of how passionately the party fought and won the 2014 campaign. For one, there is every reason to believe that Modi empowered his team fully. There was minimal interference from the leadership which ensured quick decision-making, so crucial in a frenetic election campaign. When a new ad was ready, it would often be sent via WhatsApp, sometimes late in the night, to